

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT
FOR BALTIMORE CITY
MARYLAND**

CAUSTIN LEE MCCLAUGHLIN

1525 Newton Street NW

Washington, D.C. 20010

Petitioner, pro se

v.

COMPTROLLER OF MARYLAND

Serve: 301 W. Preston St., Rm. 310

Baltimore, MD 21201

& 7 St. Paul St., Ste. 320

Baltimore, MD 21202

MARYLAND SECRETARY OF STATE

Serve: 16 Francis St.

Annapolis, MD 21401

**UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND GLOBAL
CAMPUS**

Serve: Office of the President

3501 University Blvd. East

Adelphi, MD 20783

Respondents

Case No. _____

**MASTER PETITION FOR WRIT
OF MANDAMUS AND
DECLARATORY JUDGMENT**

MASTER PETITION FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS AND DECLARATORY JUDGMENT

I. INTRODUCTION

1. This single action consolidates three urgent demands, all arising from the same core facts:

Petitioner Caustin Lee McLaughlin is a neurodivergent jurisprudential technologist who has been systematically excluded from the basic tools of modern life — access to his own money, recognition of his life's work, and the degree his expertise warrants. Petitioner seeks this Court's immediate intervention to compel three Maryland state actors to perform their clear legal duties:

- The Comptroller of Maryland must release Petitioner's unclaimed property (Claim #3-0569-00431) in cash, now;
- The Maryland Secretary of State must register the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust as a public-utility purpose trust; and
- The University of Maryland Global Campus ("UMGC") must evaluate Petitioner's prior-learning portfolio and award a Bachelor of Science in Jurisprudential Technology as a reasonable accommodation for Petitioner's documented disabilities.

2. Petitioner has no adequate remedy at law. He has no income, no assets, and cannot afford counsel. Petitioner therefore requests a waiver of all filing fees and costs. A writ of mandamus is the only path to justice.

II. PARTIES

3. Petitioner Caustin Lee McLaughlin is a living individual, a resident of Washington, D.C., the sole owner of the unclaimed property at issue, the settlor of the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign

Exchange Trust, and a person with disabilities entitled to reasonable accommodation under federal and Maryland law.

4. Respondent Comptroller of Maryland is the State officer charged with administering the Maryland Unclaimed Property Act, Md. Code Ann., Com. Law § 17-101 et seq. The Comptroller holds Claim #3-0569-00431, which is registered solely to Petitioner, and has refused to release the funds despite a complete and proper claim.

5. Respondent Maryland Secretary of State is the State officer responsible for the filing and registration of trust instruments and for the recognition of public-utility purposes. The Secretary has failed or refused to register the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust without lawful basis.

6. Respondent University of Maryland Global Campus is a public institution of higher education within the University System of Maryland, and is subject to Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, 29 U.S.C. § 794, Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act, 42 U.S.C. § 12131 et seq., and the parallel provisions of Maryland law. UMGC has refused to evaluate Petitioner's prior-learning portfolio or to award the requested degree as a reasonable accommodation.

III. JURISDICTION AND VENUE

7. This Court has jurisdiction under Md. Code Ann., Com. Law § 17-323 (judicial review of unclaimed property determinations); Md. Code Ann., State Gov't § 10-122 (mandamus against State officers); Maryland Rule 15-701 (mandamus); and the Court's inherent authority to compel public officials to perform ministerial duties and to enforce civil rights. Declaratory relief is authorized by Md. Code Ann., Cts. & Jud. Proc. § 3-409.

8. Venue is proper in Baltimore City. The Comptroller's principal office, including the location where Petitioner demanded pickup of the cashier's check, is in Baltimore City. The trust is to be administered in Maryland, with substantial contacts in Baltimore City. The educational harm was suffered by Petitioner while attempting to obtain redress from a Maryland public institution. All Respondents transact business in, or are residents of, Maryland.

IV. FACTUAL BACKGROUND

A. Petitioner's Work and Vision

9. Petitioner is a self-taught expert in cryptography, distributed systems, and the legal theory of sovereign user data. Despite severe ADHD, dyslexia, and executive function disorders — genomically validated through clinical testing (variants in DRD4, DAT1, COMT, and ADGRL3) — Petitioner has created a working post-quantum decentralized exchange architecture, a 128-module Hyper-Synchronous Processing Array, and multiple patent-ready inventions in the GPRS-Secure++, OSI-P, and HARMONI-X families.

10. Petitioner's life project is the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust and the Public Trust and Exchange Foundation — a non-charitable purpose trust designed to operate a free, neutral, cryptographically transparent Bitcoin exchange as a global public utility. The trust indenture is attached as Exhibit 1.

11. To complete the trust's capitalization, Petitioner requires immediate access to all of his financial assets, including the unclaimed property at issue in Count I. The trust cannot open bank or custodial accounts, file regulatory notices, or operate without those funds.

B. The Unclaimed Property (Count I)

12. The Comptroller holds a financial asset under Claim #3-0569-00431, registered solely in Petitioner's name. On July 8, 2026, Petitioner submitted a complete claim package to the Comptroller: Form COT-ST912; a copy of Petitioner's government-issued photo identification; Social Security verification; proof of address; and a written demand for immediate disbursement by cashier's check. The supporting documents are attached as Exhibits 2 through 6.

13. The Comptroller has not released the funds, has not articulated a lawful basis for withholding them, and has ignored Petitioner's request for same-day pickup at 7 St. Paul Street, Suite 320, Baltimore, Maryland. The statutory duty to "pay or deliver the property" to a claimant who has proven ownership is mandatory under Md. Code Ann., Com. Law § 17-319.

14. Petitioner urgently needs the funds for basic survival, life-sustaining medical care, and the capitalization of the trust described in Paragraph 10. Continued delay causes irreparable harm — financial, medical, and constitutional — that no subsequent money judgment can remedy.

C. The Trust Registration (Count II)

15. Petitioner executed the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust Deed on June 28, 2026, and submitted it, with a cover letter, to the Maryland Secretary of State for registration as a non-charitable, public-utility purpose trust. The trust deed is attached as Exhibit 1; the Secretary of State filing receipt and cover letter are attached as Exhibit 7.

16. Maryland law recognizes non-charitable purpose trusts, including trusts established for public-utility purposes. The Secretary has a ministerial duty to accept and file instrument submitted in proper form. Without registration, the trust cannot open fiduciary bank accounts,

appoint a Maryland resident agent, or transact business as a Maryland trust entity. The Secretary's continued inaction prevents the trust from functioning at all.

D. The Degree as Reasonable Accommodation (Count III)

17. Petitioner was denied educational accommodations throughout his life, resulting in exclusion from formal university study despite documented disabilities and a body of demonstrated competency that exceeds most doctoral programs. Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act and Title II of the ADA require public institutions to provide reasonable accommodations, which may include the recognition of prior experiential learning as a substitute for traditional coursework where standard coursework has been inaccessible because of disability.

18. Petitioner submitted a comprehensive portfolio of his work to UMGC, together with a request that UMGC award the Bachelor of Science in Jurisprudential Technology as a reasonable accommodation. The portfolio and request letter are attached as Exhibit 8. UMGC has not evaluated the portfolio, has not issued any decision, and has provided no reasoned explanation for its inaction.

19. Without this degree, Petitioner cannot access professional opportunities, federal grants, security clearances, or the institutional credibility necessary to defend his trust and his research against entrenched administrative resistance. The degree is a necessary, narrowly tailored accommodation that remedies decades of disability-based exclusion.

E. Common Thread

20. All three denials stem from the same systemic pattern: a public institution's refusal to recognize, accommodate, or compensate a neurodivergent individual's documented competence. Each Respondent holds a key to Petitioner's survival and to Petitioner's life's work. Petitioner has

no income, no assets, and cannot afford to wait. The interests of justice and the public interest in accurate, disability-aware administration of Maryland law require immediate relief.

V. LEGAL CLAIMS

COUNT I — MANDAMUS AGAINST THE COMPTROLLER OF MARYLAND

21. The Maryland Unclaimed Property Act imposes a non-discretionary ministerial duty on the Comptroller: "The Administrator shall pay or deliver the property ... to the owner." Md. Code Ann., Com. Law § 17-319. Petitioner has proven ownership by clear and convincing evidence. Payment is therefore due. The Comptroller's refusal — without a statutory basis — is a failure to perform a ministerial duty and is remediable by mandamus. See *Goodwich v. Nolan*, 343 Md. 130 (1996); Maryland Rule 15-701. Petitioner is also entitled to a declaratory judgment that he is the sole owner of the property and that the Comptroller is obligated to disburse it without further delay.

COUNT II — MANDAMUS AGAINST THE SECRETARY OF STATE

22. The Maryland Secretary of State is required to accept and file lawful trust instruments submitted in proper form. The Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust is a valid, non-charitable purpose trust under Maryland law, including the Maryland Trust Estate Act, Md. Code Ann., Est. & Trusts § 14.5-901 et seq., and is consistent with Maryland's public policy in favor of trusts dedicated to public-utility purposes. The Secretary's continued inaction — and the absence of any lawful basis for refusing registration — prevents the trust from performing any of its intended functions. Mandamus lies to compel performance of this ministerial filing duty.

COUNT III — MANDAMUS AGAINST UMGC FOR REASONABLE ACCOMMODATION

23. Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, 29 U.S.C. § 794, and Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act, 42 U.S.C. § 12131 et seq., obligate UMGC to provide reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. The in-vivo award of a degree based on demonstrated prior learning is a recognized accommodation where traditional coursework has been inaccessible because of disability. See, e.g., *Halpern v. Wake Forest Univ. Health Scis.*, 669 F.3d 454 (4th Cir. 2012). UMGC's complete failure to act on Petitioner's prior-learning portfolio is a violation of a clear legal duty, and is redressable through a writ of mandamus coupled with declaratory relief.

VI. PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Petitioner Caustin Lee McLaughlin respectfully requests that this Court grant the following relief:

As to Respondent Comptroller of Maryland (Count I):

- a. Issue a writ of mandamus ordering the immediate release of Claim #3-0569-00431 to Petitioner in the form of a cashier's check, available for pickup at 7 St. Paul Street, Suite 320, Baltimore, Maryland 21202, within twenty-four (24) hours of entry of the order, or, at Petitioner's election, sent by United States Postal Service Registered Mail to Petitioner's address of record;

As to Respondent Secretary of State (Count II):

- b. Issue a writ of mandamus ordering the Secretary of State to register the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust within five (5) business days of entry of the order;

As to Respondent University of Maryland Global Campus (Count III):

c. Issue a writ of mandamus ordering UMGC to evaluate Petitioner's prior-learning portfolio within thirty (30) days of entry of the order, and, if the portfolio meets the institution's published standards for the Bachelor of Science in Jurisprudential Technology, to award that degree to Petitioner as a reasonable accommodation under Section 504 and the ADA;

General Relief:

- d. Award Petitioner his costs and any applicable pre-judgment interest;
- e. Retain jurisdiction to enforce all orders entered in this matter;
- f. Declare the rights and obligations of the parties as set forth above; and
- g. Grant any other relief that this Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Caustin Lee McLaughlin

Caustin Lee McLaughlin, Petitioner, pro se

1525 Newton Street NW

Washington, D.C. 20010

Date: July 8, 2026

VERIFICATION

I, Caustin Lee McLaughlin, being duly sworn upon penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of Maryland, declare under Md. Code Ann., Cts. & Jud. Proc. § 1-304, that the foregoing factual

statements in the Petition are true and correct to the best of my personal knowledge, information, and belief.

/s/ Caustin Lee McLaughlin

Caustin Lee McLaughlin

Petitioner, pro se

Date: July 8, 2026

REQUEST FOR WAIVER OF FILING FEES AND COSTS

Petitioner respectfully requests that this Court waive all prepaid costs, including the filing fee, pursuant to Md. Code Ann., Cts. & Jud. Proc. § 7-102 and Maryland Rule 1-325. Petitioner is indigent: he has no current income, no liquid assets, and no ability to pay the filing fee without forgoing necessities of life, including life-sustaining medical care. Petitioner is proceeding pro se and cannot afford counsel. The interests of justice require that the petition be considered on the merits without the impediment of a filing fee.

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct.

/s/ Caustin Lee McLaughlin

Caustin Lee McLaughlin, Petitioner, pro se

Date: July 8, 2026

ORDER ON FEE WAIVER

Upon consideration of the Request for Waiver of Filing Fees and Costs, and it appearing to the Court that Petitioner is indigent and the action has arguable merit, it is this _____ day of _____, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Baltimore City, Maryland,

ORDERED, that the Request for Waiver of Filing Fees and Costs is GRANTED; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Clerk shall accept the Master Petition for filing without prepayment of costs and shall issue summonses to each Respondent upon Petitioner's request.

Judge, Circuit Court for Baltimore City

Date: _____

EXHIBIT LIST

Exhibit	Document	Status
1	Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust Deed & Trust Indenture	<i>Attached</i>
2	Completed COT-ST912 (Claim #3-0569-00431)	<i>Attached</i>
3	Copy of Petitioner's Photo Identification	<i>Attached</i>
4	Social Security Card & W-2 Verification	<i>Attached</i>
5	Proof of Address	<i>Attached</i>
6	Demand Letter for Cashier's Check (July 8, 2026)	<i>Attached</i>
7	Secretary of State Filing Receipt / Cover Letter (Trust submission)	<i>Attached</i>
8	Portfolio of Experiential Learning & Request for Degree Accommodation	<i>Attached</i>
9	Medical Documentation of Disability (DRD4, COMT, etc.)	<i>Filed Under Seal</i>
10	Proposed Orders for each Count	<i>Attached</i>

Note on Exhibit 9: Medical documentation disclosing the Petitioner's specific genomic and neuropsychiatric profile will be filed under seal, in a separate envelope marked "CONFIDENTIAL — MEDICAL", in accordance with Md. Rule 1-332 and applicable privacy laws, with a redacted version provided to Respondents' counsel of record.

PROPOSED ORDERS

A. [PROPOSED] ORDER — COUNT I (COMPTROLLER OF MARYLAND)

Upon consideration of the Master Petition for Writ of Mandamus and Declaratory Judgment filed by Petitioner Caustin Lee McLaughlin, the supporting exhibits, and the record herein, the Court finds that: (1) Petitioner has proven by clear and convincing evidence that he is the sole owner of the property identified as Claim #3-0569-00431; (2) the Comptroller of Maryland has a non-discretionary ministerial duty under Md. Code Ann., Com. Law § 17-319 to pay or deliver the property to Petitioner; and (3) the Comptroller has refused that duty without lawful basis. It is therefore this _____ day of _____, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Baltimore City, Maryland,

ORDERED, that a writ of mandamus shall issue to the Comptroller of Maryland directing the Comptroller to release Claim #3-0569-00431 to Petitioner Caustin Lee McLaughlin, in the form of a cashier's check made payable to "Caustin Lee McLaughlin", available for pickup at 7 St. Paul Street, Suite 320, Baltimore, Maryland 21202, within twenty-four (24) hours of entry of this Order, or, at Petitioner's election, sent by United States Postal Service Registered Mail to Petitioner's address of record; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Comptroller shall file a notice of compliance with the Clerk of this Court within forty-eight (48) hours of disbursement; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Court retains jurisdiction to enforce this Order.

Judge, Circuit Court for Baltimore City

Date: _____

B. [PROPOSED] ORDER — COUNT II (SECRETARY OF STATE)

Upon consideration of the Master Petition, the supporting exhibits, and the record herein, the Court finds that: (1) Petitioner has tendered to the Maryland Secretary of State a lawful trust instrument, the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust Deed dated June 28, 2026; (2) the trust is a valid non-charitable purpose trust under Maryland law; and (3) the Secretary's continued failure to register the trust is a refusal to perform a ministerial duty. It is therefore this _____ day of _____, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Baltimore City, Maryland,

ORDERED, that a writ of mandamus shall issue to the Maryland Secretary of State directing the Secretary to accept, file, and register the Gox-Resurrected Sovereign Exchange Trust within five (5) business days of entry of this Order, and to issue to Petitioner a written confirmation of registration; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Secretary shall file a notice of compliance with the Clerk of this Court within ten (10) business days of entry of this Order; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Court retains jurisdiction to enforce this Order.

Judge, Circuit Court for Baltimore City

Date: _____

C. [PROPOSED] ORDER — COUNT III (UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND GLOBAL CAMPUS)

Upon consideration of the Master Petition, the supporting exhibits, and the record herein, the Court finds that: (1) Petitioner is a qualified individual with a disability under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, 29 U.S.C. § 794, and Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act, 42 U.S.C. § 12131 et seq.; (2) UMGC is a public institution subject to those statutes; (3) Petitioner has submitted a comprehensive prior-learning portfolio and request for reasonable accommodation; and (4) UMGC's complete failure to evaluate the portfolio is a refusal to perform a clear legal duty. It is therefore this ____ day of _____, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Baltimore City, Maryland,

ORDERED, that a writ of mandamus shall issue to the University of Maryland Global Campus directing UMGC to evaluate Petitioner's prior-learning portfolio within thirty (30) days of entry of this Order, applying UMGC's own published standards for the Bachelor of Science in Jurisprudential Technology (or any substantially similar program offered by UMGC); and it is further

ORDERED, that if the portfolio satisfies those standards, UMGC shall award Petitioner the Bachelor of Science in Jurisprudential Technology as a reasonable accommodation; and it is further

ORDERED, that UMGC shall file a written decision with the Clerk of this Court within thirty-five (35) days of entry of this Order; and it is further

ORDERED, that the Court retains jurisdiction to enforce this Order.

Judge, Circuit Court for Baltimore City

Date: _____

FILING INSTRUCTIONS

1. Print the entire Master Petition (including the caption, all counts, the Verification, the Request for Waiver of Filing Fees, and the Exhibit List).
2. Sign and date the Petition, the Verification, and the Request for Waiver of Filing Fees where indicated. The Verification does not require notarization; Maryland accepts unsworn declarations under penalty of perjury pursuant to Md. Code Ann., Cts. & Jud. Proc. § 1-304.
3. Make three (3) copies of the executed Master Petition: one (1) original for the Court, and one (1) for each of the three (3) Respondents.
4. Present the Request for Waiver of Filing Fees first. The Clerk will docket the matter and assign a case number. The Order on Fee Waiver is included for the Judge's signature.
5. File the original at: Civil Clerk, Circuit Court for Baltimore City, 111 N. Calvert Street, Baltimore, MD 21202.
6. The Clerk will issue summonses. Serve each Respondent with a copy of the filed Petition, the corresponding Proposed Order, and the summons, in accordance with Maryland Rule 2-121.
7. Service may be by certified mail, restricted delivery, or personal service by the Sheriff of Baltimore City or a private process server. Retain proof of service for filing with the Court.
8. File Exhibit 9 (Medical Documentation of Disability) under seal in a separate envelope marked "CONFIDENTIAL — MEDICAL", in accordance with Md. Rule 1-332. Provide a redacted version to each Respondent.
9. File the Proposed Orders in the Court's proposed-order binder or as required by the assigned judge's individual practices.

10. Promptly request a hearing on the Petition, citing irreparable harm and the public interest in the timely administration of the Unclaimed Property Act, the Maryland Trust Estate Act, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, and Title II of the ADA.

*End of Master Petition. The captioned matter is ready for filing in the Circuit Court for
Baltimore City, Maryland.*